

Missoula's next 43,000 homes are already on the books

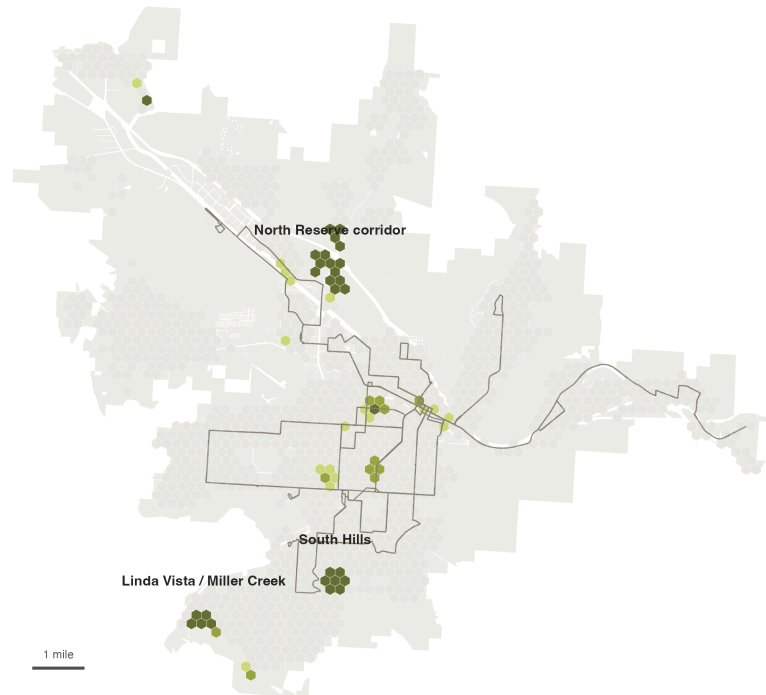
The City does not need to find new land or amend its plan: removing the friction between the adopted Growth Policy and today's code opens room for ~43,000 homes on vacant and underbuilt land — the 2045 Land Use Plan's 22,000–27,500-home target, 1.6–2× over.

Missoula's untapped housing capacity clusters in a few corridors

Green hexes hold significantly more plan-enabled capacity — counted with their neighbors — than chance would produce (Getis-Ord Gi*); darker green = stronger evidence.

— Mountain Line bus route

Moderate cluster (90% confidence) Strong cluster (95% confidence)
Very strong cluster (99% confidence) No significant clustering



~43,000

plan-enabled homes on 3,419
vacant and underbuilt parcels
— no plan change needed

54%

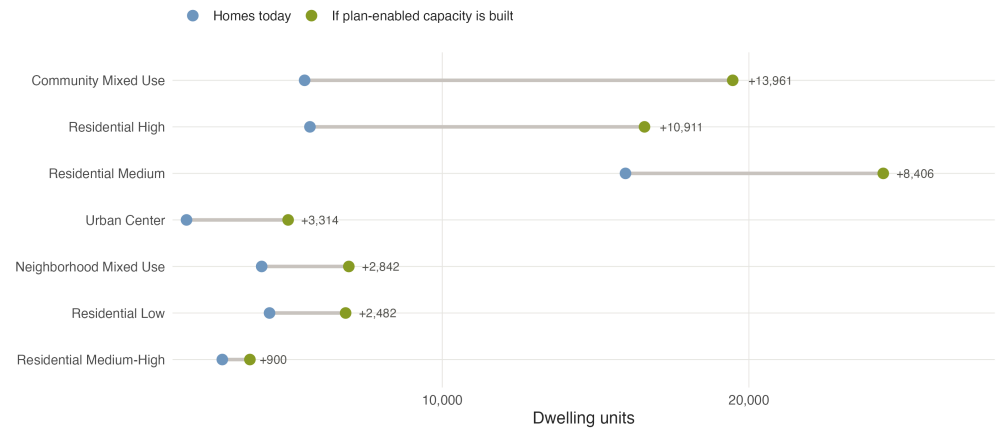
of capacity is infill on parcels ≤
5 acres — unlocked by code,
not land assembly

58%

of this capacity is within a ¼-
mile walk of a Mountain Line
bus stop

The Growth Policy already makes room for ~43,000 more homes

Dwelling units by Growth Policy future land-use designation (not current zoning):
today vs. with capacity on vacant and underbuilt parcels



Plan-enabled capacity = allowable density x developable acres on unconstrained soft parcels, net of existing units. Densities: midpoints of the adopted 2035 Growth Policy designation ranges.

What this means for the code reform

1. Align zoning with the plan in the hot-spot clusters (North Reserve, Linda Vista/Miller Creek, South Hills) — where entitlement friction costs the most homes.
2. Make small infill by-right: half the capacity sits on parcels a small builder can develop under simple rules.
3. Pair upzoning with mobile-home park preservation before surrounding land values move.

The affordability stakes: Half of Missoula's renters are cost-burdened (ACS 2019–2023), and ~2,600 of the city's lowest-cost homes sit in or beside the capacity clusters — not counted above. Preservation must move with upzoning.